

Samsung SyncMaster 932B

Black and lovin' it

With a design similar to that of the ultra-sexy Bordeaux series we reviewed earlier, the 19-inch 932B is all curves. Monitors just can't go wrong with piano black!

Build quality is excellent, and the curvy body is definitely a relief from all the monitors we've seen in recent days. The stand tries to keep up with aesthetics but could use a little more creativity in that direction.

The menu buttons are underneath the bottom bezel—good looks, but they come at the cost of usability.

The 932B uses a TN panel, with decent on-paper specifications—a 700:1 contrast ratio and a brightness of 300 cd/m². A response time of 5 ms is good enough for most applications.

Our DisplayMate tests showed good screen pixel resolution. Colour

separation was good, and the 932S did well with the primary colours. All this means the 932S is good for working with applications that use a lot of colour.

In our game tests, *F.E.A.R.* looked crisp: good contrast, and good colour and detailing. Ditto *Oblivion*. Movie playback was also good—great colours. Our only grouse is that it's not widescreen.



Contact: Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 011-41511234
E-mail: rengith.nair@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsungindia.com
Price: Rs 19,000

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

Contrast ratio: TN panel, 3000:1 (700:1 actual); lumens: 300 cd/m²; 19-inch TFT; native resolution 1280 x 1024; response time: 5 ms.

Billion BIPAC 7402G 802.11g ADSL2+ VPN Firewall Router

Your broadband facilitator

This is an ADSL modem, four-port router, and wireless access point all in one—just what you need to share an Internet connection on your home network. A firmware upgrade gives it ADSL2/2+ compliance as well.

It supports enhanced wireless security using WPA and WEP. The integrated firewall has NAT and SPI capabilities, and can ably handle DoS attacks. URL and domain blocking is

supported, too. Also featured is the inbuilt IPSec VPN with DES, 3DES and AES encryption.

Wi-Fi speeds are blazing fast. The device transferred a sequential file at 2.5 MB/s in the closest zone, while managing 1.19 in the

farthest zone, making it at least 50 per cent faster than its closest competitors, the Netgear DG834G and the D-Link DSL-2640T.

If you are setting up a home network, this is a must-buy.



cables: CAT-5 UTP Ethernet, RJ-11 (telephone), PS/2/RS-232

Contact: One Network (India) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-26056300
E-mail: sales@onenetwork.co.in
Web site: www.billion.com
Price: Rs 9,500

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

ADSL compliant (ADSL2 via firmware upgrade); ports: 1 x ADSL RJ-11 for 24/26 AWG twisted-pair telephone wire; 4 x 10/100 LAN RJ-45; PS/2; Wi-Fi standard: 802.11b/g;

Canon PowerShot A460

A well-priced entry-level cam

The 5 MegaPixel Canon PowerShot A460 is out to make a point that you don't need to have an expensive digital camera to take good shots. While a bit bulky, the A460 still looks OK. You can choose from five modes for different types of photo and video shooting and previewing.

The custom timer lets you choose the timing and the number of the shots to be taken. The Slow Synchro synchronises the flash with slower shutter speeds to effectively prevent

background blackouts while using the flash.

The quality of the photos is pretty good—not too vibrant or enhanced, but some purple



fringing can be seen along bright edges.

Movie recording performance is pretty appalling with just 10 fps at 640 x 480.

One irritant is that the camera must be switched to Playback mode to transfer images. ZoomBrowser EX, a plain-looking bundled

software, enables the camera to send images to a PC at a press of a button.

You get a set of batteries but no charger. The camera is well priced at Rs 9,795. It's an easy camera and good for beginners, and will allow you to take some impressive shots as well.

Specifications

5 megapixel; 4x optical zoom; aperture: f/2.8–f/5.8; ISO levels: 80–400; shutter speed: 15–1/2000 second

Contact: Canon India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1800-345-33-66
E-mail: info@canon.co.in
Web site: www.canon.co.in
Price: Rs 9,795

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★